

Plays





About the Course

Students read Shakespeare's plays with additional optional readings and extra helpings from the time period.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grade 11, Literature: Grade 12, Literature: Grade 9, Literature: Grade 10

Plays: Grades 9-12

William Shakespeare (1564-1616) is perhaps the greatest writer in the English language. Reading and speaking his beautiful words will delight students as they learn his timeless stories, meet a variety of characters, enrich their minds, and instruct their consciences. Students will begin by simply enjoying the plays and later by writing short compositions, comparisons, and commonplace entries. Shakespeare covers the wide panorama of human experience through his nearly 40 plays; the comedies, tragedies, and histories that students read will spark their imaginations with stories that transcend time and culture.



Placement & Combining Tips

This year, this course is the same as Shakespeare for Grades 5-8 with the only difference coming in Extra Helpings and additional options for further study.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9-12	Plays: Grades 9-12 1 time/week 30 min	The Tempest The Tempest (Audio recording) Henry IV Part 2 Henry IV Part 2 (Audio recording) The Winter's Tale The Winter's Tale (Audio recording)

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 9				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 9		General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Poetry Study: Grade 9	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Plays: Grades 9-12 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 10				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 10 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12		General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	Poetry Study: Grade 10	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Plays: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 11				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Plays: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 12				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12		General Lit.: Grades 11-12	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Reading:



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Plays: Grades 9-12

- ☐ You may want to read "Shakespeare and a Christian Worldview," which is Ch.9 in the book *Echoes of Eden – Reflections on Christianity, Literature, and the Arts* by Jerram Barrs. This is an excellent overview of why Shakespeare is important for everyone to know, including Christians.
- ☐ If your students are new to Shakespeare, read the tips for beginners (Found in Appendix link)
- ☐ You may want to read a retelling beforehand so you are familiar with the play. (Suggestions found in Extra Helpings)
- ☐ Read the discussion questions and skim the summaries of each scene each week before the reading to help guide emphasis and discussion with your students.
- ☐ Consider purchasing puppets to use while reading to keep track of all the characters.

NOTE on VERSIONS

Students should have an unabridged copy that is not in a modern language edition, such as the ones linked in the program. The language complexity gets easier to understand with practice. (Note: Shakespeare's work does often contain bawdy jokes or off-color content that will go over the heads of students if left in its original form; a modern language version will lay it all right out there in plain, modern English.) We like the Folger editions because they are inexpensive, the lines are numbered (making it easy to find your place), and they contain good notes. These are available on the Folger website as free PDFs as well, though the notes are omitted.

NOTE on CONTENT

Teachers are sometimes wary of reading Shakespeare with their students because the plays do contain material that they would deem inappropriate. The Alveary generally follows Mason's programs for younger students. That does not mean, however, that your student will never encounter anything unsavory. Our best advice is to read in such a way that these things are moved over quickly, without added attention being drawn to them. Mason assures us that Shakespeare provides students with rich language and character lessons that are unparalleled.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Plays: Grades 9-12



The Tempest



The Tempest (Audio recording)



Henry IV Part 2



Henry IV Part 2 (Audio recording)



The Winter's Tale



The Winter's Tale (Audio recording)



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Plays: **Grades 9-12**

∞ [Extra Helpings](#)

∞ [Appendix: Ideas for Students New to Shakespeare](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Related Course Quick Links

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

Plays: Grades 9-12

How To Approach



Read

The lesson plans will guide you through what to read over the terms. Take a moment before reading to remember where you left off last time.



Narrate

The lesson plans will give you specific instructions or tell you to choose a way to narrate that helps you interact with the ideas.



Discuss

The lesson plans will guide you with questions or instructions to share your ideas or what you are reading with others.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are occasionally added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

It is also valuable for those in a classroom setting to have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrate together. Literature lessons lend themselves well to a larger discussion time at the end of the lesson where student can share their ideas.

Plays: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 1

Materials: The Tempest

PREP: Read an overview of the play (one synopsis is located at the beginning of the Folger edition of the play). If you are not familiar with the play, you will want to read other retellings. We highly suggest Stories from Shakespeare by Marchette Chute. Resources are listed on the Extra Helpings Page. Also, be sure to read the note about mature content and language in Shakespeare in the Planning and Prep section.

→ INTRO

• What makes a tragedy a tragedy or a comedy a comedy?

• Our play this term is sometimes called a tragicomedy because it has both comedic and tragic elements. Overall, the play has a happy ending, which places it in the comedic category. The name of the play 'Tempest' means "a violent storm," and it will give us lots of things to ponder about power, betrayal, magic, slavery, and the restoration of relationships.

• Take time to review the elements of tragedy and comedy before beginning.

∞ Link: Genres of Shakespeare

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 1: Scene 1-2 p.7-25 "Boatswain!" - "Approach, my Ariel. Come."

• How does each character respond to the storm? What is the tone of this scene?

• Re-read lines 84-95. Discuss the context this gives for the story.

• Put the following quote from Miranda into your own words. What does it tell us about what Miranda is like?

"A brave vessel,
Who had, no doubt, some noble creature in her,
Dashed all to pieces. O, the cry did knock
Against my very heart! Poor souls, they perished.
Had I been any god of power, I would
Have sunk the sea within the earth or ere
It should the good ship so have swallowed, and
The fraughting souls within her."

★ TEACHER TIP

Take turns reading the play aloud if using these lessons in a group. We recommend reading the summaries of each scene to briefly preview content and help orient students.

WEEK 2 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 2

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

How did Prospero and Miranda come to be on the island?

→ INTRO

The Tempest explores the theme of power, and we see this in Prospero's relationships. Watch a portion of Act 1, Scene 2, to learn more about Prospero's relationship to Ariel.

∞ Video Link: Act 1, Scene 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 1 Scene 2 p.25-39 "All hail, great master!" - "So, slave, hence."

• How would you describe Prospero's relationship with Caliban and Ariel?

• Put this quote by Caliban into your own words: "This island's mine by Sycorax, my mother, Which thou tak'st from me."

Plays: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 3 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 3

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

Think back on what you learned about Ariel and Caliban through Prospero's conversations with and about them. What is your opinion of Prospero at this point?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 1 Scene 2 p.41-49 "Come unto these" - "Speak not for him."

- What does Ferdinand think of Miranda? How do you think this relationship will develop or change?

→ ACTIVITY

With the remaining time, let's dig into Caliban's speech from earlier in this scene to work to stretch our imaginations and seek to understand his world from his perspective as well as Prospero's.

∞ Link: Caliban Visual

★ TEACHER NOTE

The activity at the end of the lesson requires you to be present. Also, there are more layers to the activity than will likely fit in the remaining time after the reading is done. The point is to practice seeing the play from a different perspective, so feel free to stop at the end of the lesson time and move on or continue the activity if desired and time allows.

WEEK 4 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 4

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

What is the setting (background story and situation) of The Tempest?

→ INTRO

The setting of The Tempest is unique. The play takes place on a remote island (meaning no one lives there) with the exception of Caliban and Ariel. This island is in the Mediterranean Sea. However, there are two important Italian Kingdoms mentioned – Naples and Milan. Prospero and Miranda, as well as the characters who crashed on the island, are from these kingdoms. Let's review the map and the character list. Consider sketching a map in your notebook.

∞ Map Link: Tempest and Kingdoms

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scene 1 p.53-65 "Beseech you, sir" - "Go sleep, and hear us."

- What does this scene show about the characters of Antonio and Sebastian? How does it compare to Alonso's behavior?

WEEK 5 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 5

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

Explain the reason for King Alonso's having sailed from Tunis. What does he think of ever setting out for Tunis in the first place?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scene 1 p.65-75 "What, all soon" - "to seek thy son."

- How would you describe Alonso and Antonio's relationship?

WEEK 6 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 6

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

What does Antonio propose that Sebastian do? How is this proposal

Plays: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

similar to Antonio's actions towards his brother, Prospero?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scene 2 p.77-87 "All the infections" - "Lead the way."

- What is loyalty? How does loyalty motivate characters?

WEEK 7 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 7

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

Describe Trinculo's account of his meeting Caliban.

→ INTRO

Act 3, Scene 2 highlights a lot of the conflict in The Tempest. Pay attention to how Caliban and Ariel both use deception for different purposes.

→ READ & NARRATE

Act 3 Scene 1-2 p.91-109 "There be some" - "I'll follow, Stephano."

→ DISCUSS

Pretend you are an investigative reporter covering Caliban's plot to overthrow Prospero in Act 3, Scene 2. Look back at the scene and see what evidence you can find to explain the conspiracy to the public. Use these questions to guide you:

1. What is Caliban's plan?
2. Why does Caliban want Stephano to rule the island?
3. How does Ariel disrupt the plan and cause confusion?
4. Is Stephano a strong leader? Does he do anything to suggest he isn't?

• EXTRA HELPING

Have students watch a portion of Act 3, Scene 2.

∞ Video Link: Act 3, Scene 2

• COMPOSITION - News Report
Build on the discussion from the lesson and create a news report. If you are doing these lessons alone, write up your findings as a news article. If you can pull in some family members or classmates, work together to plan out and present either a live broadcast (have a host interview several news reporters on the island) or even an interview show (have a host interview the characters of Caliban, Stephano, Trinculo, and Ariel in a heated discussion).

WEEK 8 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 8

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

What plan does Caliban propose to Stephano?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 3 Scene 3 - Act 4 Scene 1 p.109-125 "By 'r lakin" - "All eyes. Be Silent."

- What is the purpose of the magical banquet? How do people respond to the banquet?

WEEK 9 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 9

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

Recall the conversation Prospero has with Ferdinand about his daughter, Miranda. What is your opinion of him as a father?

→ INTRO

This scene has a famous monologue with the phrase, "Our revels now are ended." Let's take some time to watch the clip before reading the scene.
∞ Video Link: Act 4, Scene 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 4 Scene 1 p.125-141 "Ceres, most bounteous" - "do me service."

Plays: Grades 9-12

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Term 1

- Prospero deals with a lot of inner conflict (conflict within himself). How do we see Prospero resolving these inner conflicts?

WEEK 10 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 10

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

Think back on what wishes Juno and Ceres bestow upon Ferdinand and Miranda at the masque. Reference Act 4 Scene 1 L119-130. What other blessings would you add if you were at their engagement party?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 5 Scene 1 p.145-157 "Now does my project" - "me my dukedom."

- Why does Prospero choose to forgive his enemies instead of seeking revenge? What does this say about his character?

• EXTRA HELPING

Have students watch a portion of Act 5, Scene 1. As students near the end of the play, have them consider concepts and characters that have run throughout. Use this fun, interactive activity from the Royal Shakespeare Company to get them thinking about these concepts.

∞ Video Link: Act 5, Scene 1

∞ Link: Tempest Shapes

WEEK 11 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 11

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

Recollect the scene in which Prospero draws a charmed circle with his staff. What does he say to those brought into the circle?

→ INTRO

Many consider The Tempest Shakespeare's final work. Therefore, Prospero's farewell is often double-read as Shakespeare's farewell to the audience. Before reading the scene, watch Prospero's epilogue.

∞ Video Link: Prospero's Epilogue

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 5 Scene 1 p.157-171 "Sweet lord" - "indulgence set me free."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

EPILOGUE p.169 & 171

- Why do you think Shakespeare chose to end the play with Prospero asking for the audience's "indulgence" (approval)?

→ READ & DISCUSS

If time permits, read the article on the epilogue.

∞ Article Link: Epilogue

• EXTRA HELPING

The resolution of The Tempest is very complex. To help students connect the dots, have students play this review game. Students will be asked to fill in the quote, find answers, and escape the island!

∞ Link: Escape the Island Game

WEEK 12 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
The Tempest

Plays: Grades 9-12

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Term 2

WEEK 1 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 13

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ INTRO

Henry IV Part 2 is a tale about Prince Hal falling into his father's footsteps as king. Hal's life will no longer be the same when he feels the weight of the crown. Henry IV Part 2 is actually the third play in a tetralogy. The Henriad is all about Henry becoming the warrior king. Let's take time to review the first 6 slides on the Henriad plays to better understand the play.

∞ Link: Henriad

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Induction - Act 1 Scene 1 p.7-25 "Open your ears," - "yet more need."

- What role do you think Northumberland will play in this story?

★ TEACHER TIP

Refresh yourself, if desired, on Shakespeare's plays and biography to share "by the way," especially the section on how Shakespeare structures his histories. Remember to read the summaries before a scene to help orient students and explore retellings if desired.

∞ Link: Genres of Shakespeare

WEEK 2 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 14

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ INTRO

While Shakespeare's plays are rooted in history, there are differences in the historical characters. Let's review the historical Prince Henry slide together.

∞ Link: Henriad

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 1 Scenes 2-3 p.27-49 "Sirrah, your giant," - "time bids begone."

- What is Falstaff's relationship with money and fame? Put this quote by him into your own words: "I can get no remedy against this consumption / of the purse. Borrowing only lingers and lingers / it out, but the disease is incurable" (lines 242-244).

WEEK 3 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 15

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ RECAP

Reread Act 1, Scene 3 lines 121-130. What insight do these lines give us into the characters of King Henry IV and Prince Hotspur (Percy)?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scenes 1-2 p.53-75 "Master Fang," - "Follow me, Ned."

- If you were friends with Falstaff, what advice would you give him?

WEEK 4 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 16

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scenes 3-4 p.77-95 "I pray thee," - "at your belly."

- What do you think is Northumberland's motive to join the rebellion?

Plays: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 5 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 17

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ INTRO

Have you ever been given a responsibility that you didn't want? Or maybe the task you were given made you nervous? In the clip we're about to watch, we see how being a king is a big responsibility.

∞ Video Link: Act 3, Scene 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scene 4- Act 3 Scene 1 p.95-115 "Have you turned" - "the Holy Land."

- How do we see the weight of the crown affecting King Henry?
- Put this quote by King Henry into your own words: "Uneasy lies the head that wears a crown ... O God, that one might read the book of fate / And see the revolution of the times / Make mountains level, and the continent, / Weary of solid firmness, melt itself / Into the sea" (lines 31; 45-49).

WEEK 6 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 18

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ INTRO

Before reading the scene, let's watch a famous monologue from Falstaff called "The Chimes at Midnight." Keep in mind that Falstaff is about to lead a regiment into war.

∞ Video Link: The Chimes at Midnight

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 3 Scene 2 p.117-137 "Come on, come on," - "there an end."

- What do you think the chimes of midnight mean?

WEEK 7 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 19

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 4 Scene 1 p.141-167 "What is this" - "yielder-up of breath."

- Who is John of Lancaster? What were some skills he demonstrated in the scene?

• EXTRA HELPING

Have students draw two circles. Have them label one "Sir John Falstaff," and the other "Prince Hal." From there, list other characters who are related or have a significant relationship with those two characters.

WEEK 8 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 20

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ INTRO

The real-life Henry IV had health problems that Shakespeare hints at in the play. Let's review slide 13 to see how the king's health decline plays a role in the story.

∞ Link: Henriad

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 4 Scenes 2-3 p.167-187 "What's your name," - "(Softly, pray.)"

- How has Hal and his father's relationship changed throughout the series? Do you think King Henry believes his son can be king?

Plays: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 9 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 21

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ INTRO

As we have seen, the relationship between Prince Hal and King Henry is complicated. In the clip we will watch, we will see how the crown complicates the relationship between the father and son.

∞ Video Link: Act 4, Scene 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 4 Scene 3 p.187-203 "Let there be" - "shall Harry die."

- Why is King Henry mad at Prince Hal?
- Put this quote from the scene into your own words:

"No, I will sit and watch here by the King.
Why doth the crown lie there upon his pillow,
Being so troublesome a bedfellow?
O polished perturbation, golden care,
That keep'st the ports of slumber open wide
To many a watchful night!"

WEEK 10 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 22

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ INTRO

Let's take a few minutes to recall key events. Create a list or a series of stick-figure drawings of some of the most important scenes in Henry IV Part 2.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 5 Scenes 1-2 p.207-223 "By cock and pie," - "life one day."

- How would you describe Falstaff's relationship with Henry? Do you think Henry can remain friends with Falstaff?

WEEK 11 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 23

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 5 Scene 3 - Epilogue p.223-245 "Nay, you shall" - "bid you good night."

- Why does Henry say he doesn't know Falstaff?

★ TEACHER TIP

Have students review the PBS infographic to help them tie the narrative together.

∞ Link: Henry Part 2 Map

WEEK 12 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Henry IV Part 2

Plays: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 25

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

Like The Tempest, The Winter's Tale is not a traditional tragedy or comedy but another tragicomedy. Let's review the elements of tragedies and comedies.

∞ Link: Genres of Shakespeare

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 1 Scenes 1-2 p.7-25 "Archidamus, a Bohemian" - "an honest man."

- Why is Leontes suspicious of Hermione and Polixenes? What does this reveal about his character at the start of the play?

★ TEACHER TIP

Refresh yourself, if desired, on Shakespeare's plays and biography to share "by the way," especially the section on how Shakespeare structures his tragedies and comedies. Remember to read the summaries before a scene to help orient students and explore retellings if desired.

∞ Link: Genres of Shakespeare

WEEK 2 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 26

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

Let's watch Act 1, Scene 2, and get an understanding of the conflict of the play. King Leontes' jealousy is the basis for the conflict of the play. Shakespeare uses the word 'cuckholded' to describe adultery. To gain a deeper understanding, consult the Oxford Dictionary.

∞ Video Link: Act 1, Scene 2

∞ Link: Cuckolded Definition

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 1 Scene 2 p.25-43 "Camillo, this great" - "Come, sir, away."

- How do Camilo's actions contrast with the kings'? What does this reveal about his character?

WEEK 3 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 27

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

Before reading, let's watch a clip from Act 2, Scene 1.

∞ Video Link: Act 2, Scene 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scenes 1-2 p.47-67 "Take the boy" - "betwixt you and danger."

- How does Leontes's treatment of Hermione affect those around him, especially Mamillius?

WEEK 4 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 28

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scene 3 p.67-83 "Nor night nor day" - "upon my bidding."

- What is internal conflict? How does internal conflict within Leontes lead to external conflicts?

Plays: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 5 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 29

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

Before reading, let's watch a clip from Act 3, scene 2.

∞ Video Link: Act 3, Scene 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 3 Scenes 1-2 p.87-105 "The climate's delicate" - "To these sorrows."

- Act 3 is considered a turning point in the play. What changes do we see in Leontes, other characters, or in the plot?
- Put this quote into your own words: "Hermione is chaste, Polixenes blameless, Camillo a true subject, Leontes a jealous tyrant, his innocent babe truly begotten; and the King shall live without an heir if that which is lost be not found."

WEEK 6 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 30

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

In this scene, we will encounter a puzzling stage direction: "He exits, pursued by a bear." One question that interpreters ask is, Did they use a real bear? At the time, chained-up bears were used as live entertainment. Many have speculated whether or not the Bard would have used an actual bear in a live performance. Since using live bears raises many safety and ethical concerns, artists have since found fun ways to enact this scene. If time permits, read the article from Folgers of the same title as the line to learn more.

∞ Article Link: Pursued by a bear

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 3 Scene 3 - Act 4 Scene 2 p.105-125 "Thou art perfect," - "disguise ourselves."

- Consider the role of fate in the play. Why is Antigonus killed but Perdita spared? Why do you think Perdita is being spared?
- Put this quote into your own words: "Imagine me, Gentle spectators, that I now may be In fair Bohemia. And remember well I mentioned a son o' th' King's, which Florizell I now name to you, and with speed so pace To speak of Perdita, now grown in grace equal with wond'ring...."

• EXTRA HELPING

Explore the Royal Shakespeare Company's Create a Bear exercise.

∞ Link: Create a Bear

WEEK 7 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 31

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

Let's watch a clip and see a 'fool' or a silly person who is mocked and made fun of.

∞ Video Link: Act 4, Scene 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 4 Scene 3 - Act 4 Scene 4 p.125-145 "When daffodils" - "Come, strike up."

- In Shakespeare's day, audiences loved foolish characters. There were typically three types of fools:
Natural Fools – Characters who are foolish by nature, often used for humor.

• EXTRA HELPING

Explore this fun and informative exercise, Act Like a Fool! In Shakespeare's day, audiences loved foolish characters. In The Winter's Tale, Autolycus is the play's fool. In Act Like a Fool, students will try to play the role in the most ridiculous and funny way they can.

∞ Link: Act Like a Fool

Plays: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

Licensed Fools – Court jesters who are intentionally silly to make others laugh.

Rogue Fools – Tricksters and con artists who use deception to survive.

In The Winter's Tale, Autolycus is the play's fool. What role does Autolycus serve in the play? What type of fool do you think he is?

WEEK 8 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 32

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

Act 4, Scene 4 is a challenging scene. One helpful framework to understand the scene is [secret-reveal] or [deception-truth]. Each main character has a secret that must be revealed. While reading, let's ask: What are those secrets? What needs to be revealed? If time permits, let's take a look at Exploring Act 4 in the Extra Helping.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 4 Scene 4 p.145-165 "Pray, good shepherd," - "to die when I desire."

- Contrast Perdita and Florizel's motives at the celebration with Polixenes and Camillo's motives at the celebration. How are they different?
- Put this quote into your own words: "That were I crowned the most imperial monarch... I would not prize [it] without her love" (Act 4, Scene 4, Lines 426, 431).

★ TEACHER NOTE

For more information, take a look at Exploring Act 4.

∞ Link: Exploring Act 4

WEEK 9 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 33

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ RECAP

What happened last?

→ INTRO

Remember, one helpful framework to understand this scene is [secret-reveal] or [deception-truth]. Keep paying attention to the secrets that still exist and the truth that needs to be revealed.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 4 Scene 4 p.165-191 "Why look you" - "be matter in it."

- Would you ever love someone if it brought conflict to your family or country? How do Florizel's values of love and duty seem to conflict in the scene?

★ TEACHER NOTE

For more information, take a look at Exploring Act 4.

∞ Link: Exploring Act 4

WEEK 10 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 34

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ RECAP

How does the sheep-shearing festival go from a joyful celebration to a moment of crisis for Perdita and Florizel?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 5 Scene 1 p.195-213 "Sir, you have" - "good my lord."

- How has Leontes changed from the beginning of the play to this scene? What has caused his transformation?

Plays: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 11 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 35

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

Before reading the famous scene on Hermione's Statue, let's read an article on the scene and note the lines they cite. While reading, we should feel a sense of magic and enchantment in this scene.

∞ Article Link: Hermione's Statue

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 5 Scenes 2-3 p.213-235 "Beseech you, sir," - "Hastily lead away."

- How does the final scene tie together the themes of reconciliation and renewal? What characters experienced renewal?

• EXTRA HELPING

Have students play the review game The Winter's Tale: Path to Reconciliation.

∞ Link: Winter's Tale: Path to Reconciliation

Watch a clip of Aslan's breath. C.S. Lewis was an English professor and was very familiar with Shakespeare's works. There is an intriguing parallel between The Winter's Tale and The Lion, the Witch, and the Wardrobe. Watch the scene, Aslan's breath, and see if the students can spot the parallel. Consider, too, how the breath of God is used in Scripture to create life (Gen. 2:7), resurrect the dead (Ezek. 37:9-10), and to impart the Holy Spirit (John 20:22).

∞ Video Link: Aslan's Breath

WEEK 12 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
The Winter's Tale

Plays: Grades 9-12

Examination

Term 1

- The Tempest: Choose one question and give as much detail as possible:
- What lesson does Prospero learn by the end of the play, and how does it change his actions?
- Is Caliban justified in his anger toward Prospero? What might motivate Caliban to plot against Prospero?
- How does Prospero use magic to control the events on the island? Do you think he is fair in his use of magic? Why or why not?

Term 2

- Henry IV, Part 2: Choose one question and give as much detail as possible:
- What struggles does King Henry IV face in this play, and how do they affect his rule?
- Do you think Prince Hal was ready to be King? Why or why not?
- How does Prince Hal's relationship with Falstaff change by the end of the play? Why does he make this decision?

Term 3

- The Winter's Tale: Choose one question and give as much detail as possible:
- Why does King Leontes wrongly accuse his wife, Hermione, and what are the consequences of his actions?
- Is King Leontes a good man? Why or why not?
- How does the story shift from tragedy to comedy? What events make this possible?